E.CELL AIT PUNE

IGNITE

A NO CODE STARTUP BUILDATHON

From idea to Startup

RULEBOOK

~Creating Synergy❤️

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General Rules

1. This event is open to all **FE**, **SE** and **TE** students.
2. You can apply individually or as a team of **2–4** members.
3. Teams may include students from different years and branches.
4. Each student can register with only **one team**.
5. Ideas from all domains and sectors are welcomed.
6. Selected participants are expected to stay committed to the entire timeline, not just the pitch.
7. Any situation not covered in these rules will be decided by the organizing committee.
8. Teams are expected to actively participate throughout the program and demonstrate **reasonable progress** at each review.

Important Remarks:

* By participation in **IGNITE**, you agreed to follow the rules and guidelines mentioned above.

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Round 1

1. Submit your idea online through the official submission form.
2. Clearly explain the problem, your proposed solution, target users, what makes your idea unique, its feasibility, and its potential impact.
3. Your idea should be original or genuinely developed by your team.
4. You can also submit an existing idea or project, but mention its current stage of development.
5. Incomplete or late submissions may not be considerd.

Important Note

* Submtting your idea is the first step towards the prolonged program, so make sure your submission reflects your idea clearly

Round 2

1. All eligible Round 1 entries will be reviewed by the evaluation committee.
2. The top-performing teams will be shortlisted for the Round 2 pitch.
3. Be prepared to answer questions about your problem, solution, target users, feasibility, business model, implementation, and scalability.
4. You can improve your idea or presentation based on the feedback received in the previous round.

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5. The panel may include industry experts, entrepreneurs, mentors, VCs, and other invited experts.
6. The final decision on shortlisting will be made by the organizing/ evaluation committee.

The Top 10 & Startup Grant

1. 10 promising startups will be selected for the main IGNITE program.
2. Selection will be based on factors like innovation, feasibility, relevance of the problem, market potential, scalability, execution, and team commitment.
3. Being selected in the Top 10 means being part of the startup-building program, not just winning a pitch competition
4. Selected teams must be willing to continue with the complete program.

Startup Development Grant

1. A total grant of ₹1,00,000 will be available for the selected Top 10 teams.
2. The grant amount for each team will be decided based on the startup-related expenses and bills submitted by the team.
3. The grant can be used for genuine startup development needs such as prototyping, materials, software, testing, hosting, and other related expenses.

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4. Teams must maintain and submit the required bills or supporting documents for their expenses.

5. If the grant is misused or not used productively, the team may be asked to return the amount received and may be removed from the program.

Mentorship & Progress

1. Selected participants will receive guidance through periodic sessions with industry experts, entrepreneurs, mentors, and VCs, subject to availability.

2. There may also be opportunities for industry or startup ecosystem visits and other external interactions.

3. Participants are expected to attend all scheduled mentorship, review, and evaluation sessions.

4. Regular progress is expected throughout the program.

5. Relevant mentor feedback should be used to improve the product and business model.

6. Repeated absence, inactivity, or lack of reasonable progress may affect continuation in the program.

Team Changes

1. Participants are expected to keep the same team members throughout the program.

2. Any addition, removal, or replacement of a team member after selection must be discussed with and approved by the I&E Cell.

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3. Any change in the team should not unfairly affect the ownership of the original idea.

4. If there is an internal issue or disagreement within the team, it should be brought to the organizing team at the earliest.

Idea Ownership & IP

1. The idea and work created by the team will remain with the team members, as per institute policy.

2. Make sure your submission does not copy or knowingly use someone else’s work or intellectual property.

3. If your idea is based on existing work, technology, or intellectual property, mention it clearly in your submission.

4. The I&E Cell may use team/startup names, photos, and non-confidential project details for IGNITE-related documentation and promotion.

Conduct

1. Everyone is expected to behave respectfully with mentors, judges, investors, founders, and other people involved in the program.

2. AIT rules and discipline must be followed during visits and activities outside the college.

3. Providing false information, copying someone else's work, or any unethical behaviour may lead to disqualification.

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Development Expectations

Idea → Validation → Prototype/MVP → Testing → Refinement → Business Model → Market Readiness → Startup

1. Test your idea with users or customers to understand if it actually solves a real problem.
2. Focus on building a working product or MVP rather than just preparing presentations.
3. Keep a record of your progress, important milestones, and what you learn along the way.
4. Be ready to show your progress during reviews with mentors or the panel.

Startup Registration

1. One of the main goals of IGNITE is to help develop 10+ registered startups from our college.
2. Selected teams will be guided through the startup registration process when their idea is ready.
3. The registration timeline will depend on the stage of the startup and the requirements involved.

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Final Pitch / Demo Day

1. Participants will present their progress through a Final Pitch or Demo Day on 25th October.
2. The final evaluation will look at the product/MVP, validation, innovation, business potential, progress, and future plans.
3. High-performing startups may get additional recognition or opportunities, depending on what is available.

PPT Submission Template

1. Use the official PPT template provided for your IGNITE submission.
2. Make sure your presentation follows the given format and includes all the required sections.
3. You can access the PPT template here:

   https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1SazrWz4GKGJ4JEa3yAYQ3C8jI25V-Uau?usp=sharing
4. Submit your final PPT within the given deadline.